

KHUYEN LE

(650) 382-9404 | khuyenle@ucsd.edu | <https://github.com/khuyen-le/>

EDUCATION

PhD Candidate, Experimental Psychology

Advisor: David Barner

Language & Development Lab

UC San Diego, San Diego, CA

MS, Computer Science (Human-Computer Interaction), 06/2022

Stanford University, Stanford, CA

Cumulative GPA: 3.73 (weighted), 3.64 (unweighted)

BS (with Departmental Honors and Distinction), Symbolic Systems (Cognitive Science), 06/2021

BA (with Distinction), Comparative Literature, 06/2021

Stanford University, Stanford, CA

Cumulative GPA: 4.00 (weighted), 3.94 (unweighted)

Psychology GPA: 4.18 (weighted), 4.00 (unweighted)

JOURNAL PUBLICATIONS

Le, K. N., Zettersten, M. & Barner, D. (in prep). Children and adults monitor speaker ignorance to learn words cross-situationally.

Le, K. N., & Barner, D. (under review). The role of epistemic reasoning in mutual exclusivity inferences.

https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/2py3a_v1

Le, K. N., Bale, A. C., & Barner, D. (under review). Object-mass nouns specify individuation lexically:

Evidence from English and French. https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/68amw_v1

Le, K. N., Schneider, R. M., & Barner, D. (2025). The Development of Cardinal Extension: From Counting to Exact Equality. *Developmental Psychology*, 61(6), 1180–1195. <https://doi.org/10.1037/dev0001922>

Bohn, M., **Le, K. N.**, Peloquin, B., Köymen, B. & Frank, M.C. (2020). Children's interpretation of ambiguous pronouns based on prior discourse. *Developmental Science*, 24, e13049.

<https://doi.org/10.1111/desc.13049>

Staveley, A., Elott, E., **Le, K. N.**, Hou, E., & Morgan, P. (forthcoming). Virginia Woolf in Circulation: The Hogarth Press Order Books, Modernist Bookselling, and Digital Praxis. *Modernism/modernity*

PEER-REVIEWED CONFERENCE PROCEEDINGS

Le, K. N., Bale, A. C., & Barner, D. (2025). Who Has More Furniture? Context Effects on the Quantification of Mass vs. Count Superordinate Nouns. In *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society* (Vol. 47). <https://escholarship.org/uc/item/4nf1r7w9>

Le, K. N., Kwon, C., Wu, M., & Barner, D. (2024). 'Five' is the number of bunnies and hats: Children's understanding of cardinal extension and exact number. In *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society* (Vol. 46). <https://escholarship.org/uc/item/8293g6hd>.

Duan, Y., **Le, K. N.** & Lupyan, G. (2024). Differences in distributional structure can lead to differences in similarity biases. In *The Evolution of Language: Proceedings of the 15th International Conference (Evolang XV)*. <https://doi.org/10.17617/2.3587960>.

Cheng, A. Y., Guo, M., Ran, M., Ranasaria, A., Sharma, A., Xie, A., **Le, K. N.**, ... & Landay, J. A. (2024). Scientific and Fantastical: Creating Immersive, Culturally Relevant Learning Experiences with Augmented Reality and Large Language Models. In *Proceedings of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems* (pp. 1-23). <https://dl.acm.org/doi/full/10.1145/3613904.3642041>

Le, K. N., Gao, S., Frank, M. C., & Carstensen, A. (2023). Re-examining cross-cultural similarity judgments using language statistics. In *Proceedings of the Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society* (Vol. 45). <https://escholarship.org/uc/item/2gf8p2pn>

PREPRINTS & OTHERS

Le, K. N., & Barner, D. (2023). Syntax-Semantics Mappings of Superordinate Nouns: Mass-Count Syntax and Inferences about Functional Context. <https://doi.org/10.31234/osf.io/9mz3b>

Le, K. (2021). Is It Language or Is It Culture? Re-examining Cross-Cultural Similarity Judgments Using Lexical Co-Occurrence. Undergraduate honors thesis, Stanford University. Stanford Digital Repository. Available at: <https://purl.stanford.edu/kg784gg3693>

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Le, K. N., Zettersten, M. & Barner, D. (2026). What speakers don't know: Children incorporate ignorance statements to learn words cross-situationally. Talk presented at the Bi-ennial Conference of the Cognitive Development Society (CDS 2026).

Le, K. N., & Barner, D. (2025). Animal but not Dog: Children's computation of implicatures for hierarchically-structured categories. Poster presented at the 50th annual Boston University Conference on Language Development.

Le, K. N., Bale, A. C., & Barner, D. (2025). Object-mass nouns specify individuation lexically: Evidence from English and French. Talk presented in the 47th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (CogSci 2025).

Le, K. N., & Barner, D. (2025). Animal but not Dog: Children's computation of implicatures in hierarchically-structured categories. Talk presented at the 1st Southern California Meeting for Investigations in Developmental Science (SoCal MInDS 2025).

Le, K. N., & Barner, D. (2024). "Let's call this a dax!" Children and adults consider speaker knowledge when reasoning about novel labels. Talk presented at the 49th annual Boston University Conference on Language Development.

Le, K. N., Bale, A., & Barner, D. (2024). Who Has More Furniture? Context Effects on the Quantification of Mass vs. Count Superordinate Nouns. Talk presented at the 7th California Meeting of Psycholinguistics (CAMP[7]).

Le, K. N., Kwon, C., Wu, M., & Barner, D. (2024). 'Five' is the number of bunnies and hats: Children's understanding of cardinal extension and exact number. Talk presented at the 46th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (CogSci 2025).

Le, K. N., Parkinson-Coombs, O., Núñez, R., & Barner, D. (2024). Does eight equal eight? The role of counting knowledge in children's understanding of exact equality. Poster presented at the 7th Annual Mathematical Cognition and Learning Society (MCLS 2024).

Duan, Y., **Le, K. N.** & Lupyan, G. (2024). Differences in distributional structure can lead to differences in similarity biases. Talk presented at the 15th International Conference for the Evolution of Language (EvoLang XV).

Cheng, A. Y., Guo, M., Ran, M., Ranasaria, A., Sharma, A., Xie, A., **Le, K.N.,** ... & Landay, J. A. (2024). Scientific and Fantastical: Creating Immersive, Culturally Relevant Learning Experiences with Augmented Reality and Large Language Models. Talk presented at the ACM CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2024).

Le, K. N., & Barner, D. (2024). 'Five' is the number of bunnies and hats: Children's understanding of cardinal extension and exact number. Poster presented at the Bi-ennial Conference of the Cognitive Development Society (CDS 2024).

Le, K. N., Gao, S., Frank, M. C., & Carstensen, A. (2023). Re-examining cross-cultural similarity judgments using language statistics. Talk presented at the 45th Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (CogSci 2023).

Xiaotong, T.X., **Le, K.,** Cha, C., Fleet, S., & Dow, S. (2021). Crowdsourcing Exploratory Cues for Idea Browsing and Inspiration Discovery. Talk presented at the 9th AAAI Conference on Human Computation and Crowdsourcing (HCOMP 2021).

Le, K., Carstensen, A., and Frank, M.C. (2021). Re-Examining Cross-Cultural Similarity Judgments Using Lexical Co-Occurrences. Poster presented at the 43rd Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Science Society (CogSci 2021).

Le, K., Wanpei, C., & Kumar, A.P., (2016). DEAD-box RNA helicase DP103 as a novel regulator of Wnt/ β -catenin signaling pathway and promotes cancer stem cell-like behavior in triple negative breast cancers. Poster presented at Singapore Science Research Symposium, Singapore.

WORKSHOPS & GUEST LECTURES

Serious Games

09/2024

Guest lecture, PSYC 193: Psychology and Gaming

University of California, San Diego

Language in Cognitive Psychology

08/2024

Guest lecture, PSYC 105: Cognitive Psychology

University of California, San Diego	
Learning and Memory	07/2024
Guest lecture, PSYC 2: General Psychology: Biological Foundations	
University of California, San Diego	
One-to-one, equality, & number language (with David Barner)	08/2023
Workshop on Equality & Exact Number	
University of California, San Diego	

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant	09/23 – present
<i>Quantitative Methods for Graduate Students and other classes, UC San Diego</i>	
Lead sections on experimental methods, statistical analysis, reproducible research, creating online experiments, etc. for first-year PhD students in the Psychology department, and other social science graduate students.	
Teaching Assistant	09/21 – 12/21
<i>Symbolic Systems 1: Minds and Machines, Stanford University</i>	
Led sections and facilitating discussions of introductory and current concepts of cognitive science (human learning, language acquisition, artificial intelligence, etc.); held office hours and providing feedback for written work; created lesson plans.	
Teaching Coordinator	06/20 – 08/20
<i>Introduction to Neuroscience, International Youth Neuroscience Association</i>	
Coordinated efforts to create course materials and lesson plans for an introductory course on neuroscience (brain anatomy, action potentials, important brain pathways, etc.); facilitated discussions within small groups on these topics; organizing social and career development events.	
Section Leader	04/20 – 06/20
<i>Code in Place, Stanford University</i>	
Educated beginners in programming from around the world on basic programming skills and strategies key to kickstarting their journey in programming.	
Teaching Fellow	09/19 – 06/20
<i>Psychology 1: Introduction to Psychology, Stanford University</i>	
Led sections and facilitated discussions on a wide range of topics in psychology (social, developmental, cognitive, etc.); directed hands-on study of the scientific method, including literature review, hypothesis formulation, experiment and data analysis design, data report, and citation using the APA style.	
Nominated for the Zimbardo Teaching Prize for Teaching Fellows of Psychology 1.	

MENTORSHIP EXPERIENCE

Graduate Student Mentor	06/23 – present
<i>Psychology, UC San Diego</i>	
Mentor undergraduate students interested in psychological research in child development and language acquisition.	
Advising Fellow	09/20 – 06/21
<i>Symbolic Systems Program, Stanford University</i>	
Advised current and prospective Symbolic Systems students on potential academic and professional paths. Created and maintained the biweekly Symbolic Systems Advising Fellow newsletter, which	

provides information regarding seminars, job opportunities, and news related to the program. Organized the 2020 Distinguished Speaker Lecture with Dr. Lera Boroditsky (University of California, San Diego).

MENTORED UNDERGRADUATES

- Christine Kwon (Honors Thesis student, 2023-2025)
- Elizabeth Hernandez (2023)
- Mincong Wu (2023)
- Gabriella Ruiz (2023-2024)
- Jolene Nesnas (2023-2024)
- Sophia Daluraya (2023-2024)
- Nicole Zhou (2024)
- Alli Mulqueen (2024)
- Jiying Liu (2024-2025)
- Longcheng Yang (2024-2025)
- Mia Gordon (2024-2025)
- Alexa Hall (2025)
- Amiana van Dyke (2025--)
- Keilani Hernandez (2025--)
- Chelsea Melero (2025--)
- Liia Meladze (2025--)
- Mary Thathireddy (2026--)

TECHNICAL EXPERIENCE

Stats Advisor

09/22 – present

Psychology, UC San Diego

Provide support on methods and statistics for graduate students in the department. Host workshops on linear mixed-effects models, reproducible reports, and power analysis.

jsPsych Hackathon

05/25

Vassar College

Contribute to jsPsych community and create plug-ins bridging JATOS and jsPsych to support research on dyads and group interactions. Travel and accommodation awarded by organizers.

AWARDS & FUNDING

BUCLD 50 Paula Menyuk Award, 2025: \$400

UCSD Graduate and Professional Student Association Travel Grant, 2025: \$300

CogSci Diversity & Inclusion Award, 2025: \$1000

BUCLD 49 Paula Menyuk Award, 2024: \$385

MCLS foundry10 Travel Award, 2024: \$625

Anderson Travel Awards, 2023-2025: \$2480

CogSci Diversity & Inclusion Award, 2023: \$1000

Vice Provost for Undergraduate Education (VPUE) Small Research Grant, 2021: \$1500

Robert Glushko Prize for Excellence in Undergraduate Research in Symbolic Systems (for outstanding honors thesis), 2021: \$500

K. Jon Barwise Award for Distinguished Contributions to the Symbolic Systems Program (for work as Advising Fellows for the Symbolic Systems Program), 2021: \$500

Symbolic Systems Summer Program Research Stipend (for summer research internships), 2019 & 2020: \$15,000

Vice Provost for Undergraduate Education (VPUE) Departmental Grant (Linguistics), 2018: \$7000